

HISTORICAL MAPPING

The Atlas. design package

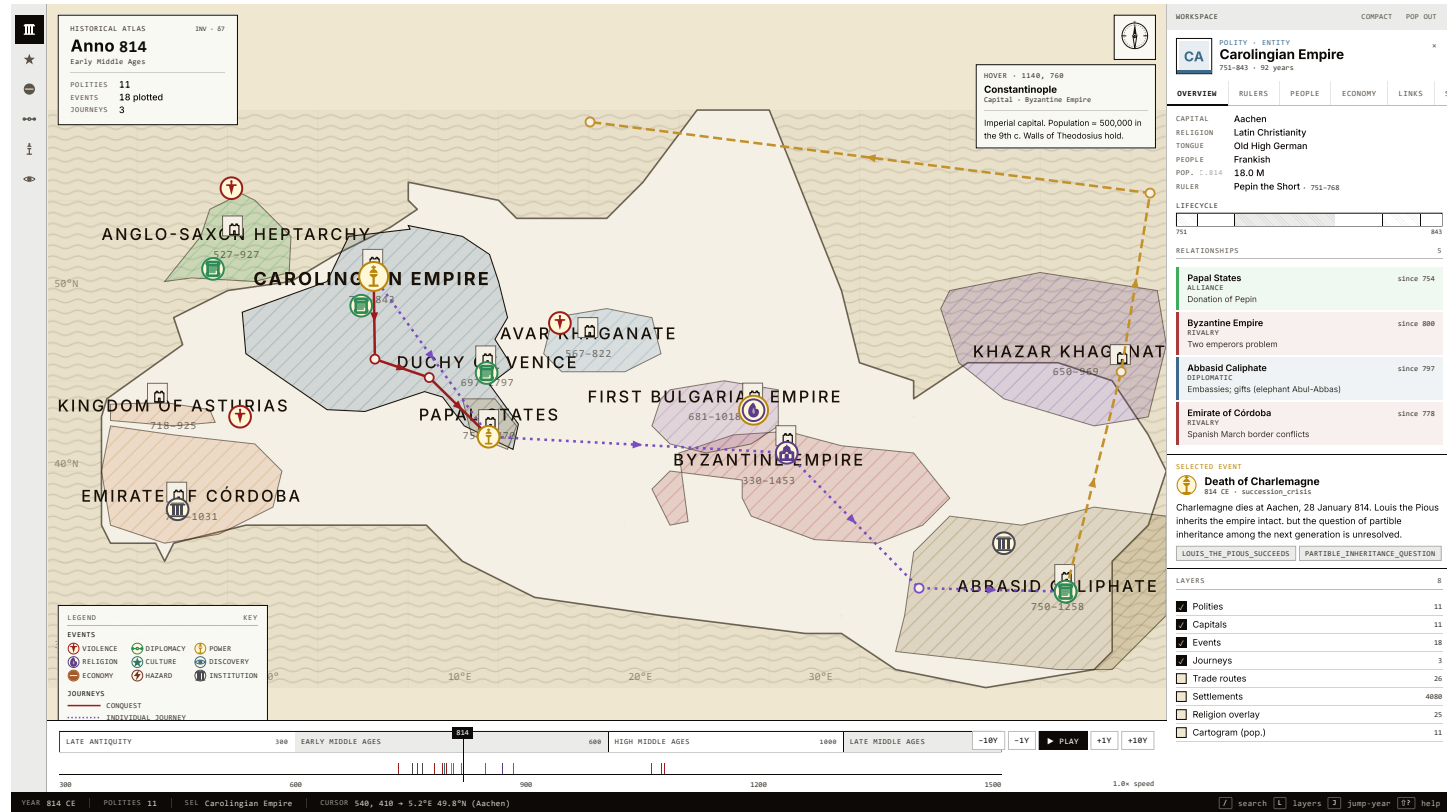
Complete design system and 31 reference artboards covering every surface in the application.
Whitepaper edition.

VERSION	v.2026.05.23
ARTBOARDS	31
PAGES	33

Contents

01 · Atlas (full mock)	p. 03
02 · EntityPanel · Overview	p. 04
03 · Chrome study	p. 05
03b · Layers & Keys	p. 06
04 · Chronoscope	p. 07
05 · Storyline	p. 08
06a · Workspace · Focus	p. 09
06b · Workspace · Compare	p. 10
06c · Workspace · Research	p. 11
07 · Component sheet	p. 12
08 · Glyph studio	p. 13
12 · User guide	p. 14
13 · Loading screen	p. 15
15 · Network + Lineage	p. 16
16 · Command palette	p. 17
17 · System states	p. 18

18 · Inspectors & tooltips	p. 19
19 · Filters & saved views	p. 20
20 · Sources library	p. 21
21 · Editing & review	p. 22
22 · Cartogram + Heatmap	p. 23
23 · Discussion	p. 24
24 · Compare table	p. 25
25 · Notifications & help	p. 26
26 · About	p. 27
27 · Onboarding	p. 28
28 · Print sheet	p. 29
29 · Data dictionary	p. 30
30 · Spec sheet	p. 31
31 · Mobile	p. 32
32 · Developer handoff	p. 33



POLITY > WESTERN EUROPE > CAROLINGIAN_EMPIRE

CA

Carolingian Empire

Imperium Romanum

751-843 · 92 years · empire

PHASE

Peak

800-814

ACTIVE IN

814

present

WLEN

Louis the Pious

814-840

STATUS

Coherent

undivided

EMPIRE

SUCCESSOR-ROME

CHRISTENDOM

OVERVIEW

RULERS

PEOPLE

ECONOMY

LINKS

SOURCES

The Frankish empire under Charlemagne and his heirs. At 814 CE the realm stretched from the Pyrenees to the Elbe and from the North Sea to central Italy, the largest unified polity in western Christendom since Rome.

At a glance KEY ATTRIBUTES

CAPITAL

Aachen

50.78°N 6.88°E

RULER C. 814

Charlemagne

768-814

RELIGION

Latin Christianity

PEOPLES

Frankish, Lombard, Saxon, Bavarian

TONGUES

Old High German, Lombardic, Latin

POPULATION

18.8 M

9th c. estimate · ± 30%

REGION

Western Europe

RECORDS

9 events · 5 titles · 4 rulers

Lifecycle 6 PHASES

FORM

CONSOLIDATE

PEAK

CRISIS

FRAGMENT

DISSOLVE

751

843

Formation

751-768

Pepin the Short crowned king of the Franks (751); Donation of Pepin (754) ties the dynasty to the papacy.

Consolidation

768-800

Charlemagne campaigns in Saxony (32 years), Italy (Lombards 774), Bavaria (788), the Spanish March, and the Avar lands.

Peak

PRESENT

800-814

Imperial coronation in Rome restores a Roman emperor in the Latin west. Aachen palace school; Carolingian Renaissance.

Succession

814-843

Louis the Pious inherits intact; rebellions of his sons; partible inheritance contested at every assembly.

Fragmentation

843-870

Treaty of Verdun (843) divides the empire three ways; subsequent treaties (Meerssen 870) redvide further.

Dissolution

870-888

Last brief reunification under Charles the Fat; deposed 887. The empire as such ceases.

Population TRAJECTORY · 9TH C.

Causal factors 14 RISE · 9 DECLINE

	RISE	DECLINE
MILITARY	5	2
ECONOMIC	3	5
RELIGIOUS	4	0
CULTURAL	2	2
POWER AND POL.	0	0

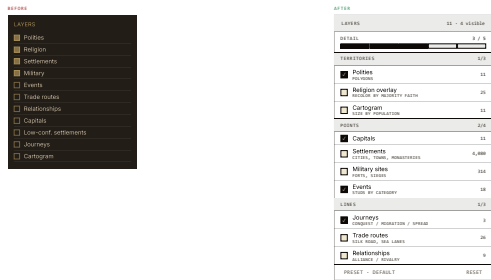
ARTBOARD - 03

Chrome study

LAYER PANEL - MAP LEGEND - COMMAND BAR, paired with the old surface they replace

A. Layer controls. parchment fold, not dark strip

Old: dark translucent strip with checkbox stack. Two problems, it punches a hole in the parchment aesthetic, and a single column of toggles can't show structure. New: lay it out as a printer's table, group by data class, expose counts and density inline. Light surface keeps the page coherent.



B. Map legend, printed key, not stacked rows

Old: vertical list, one item per row, switches with labels. New: a 3-column key block like a real atlas. Same density of information in 1/3 the height.



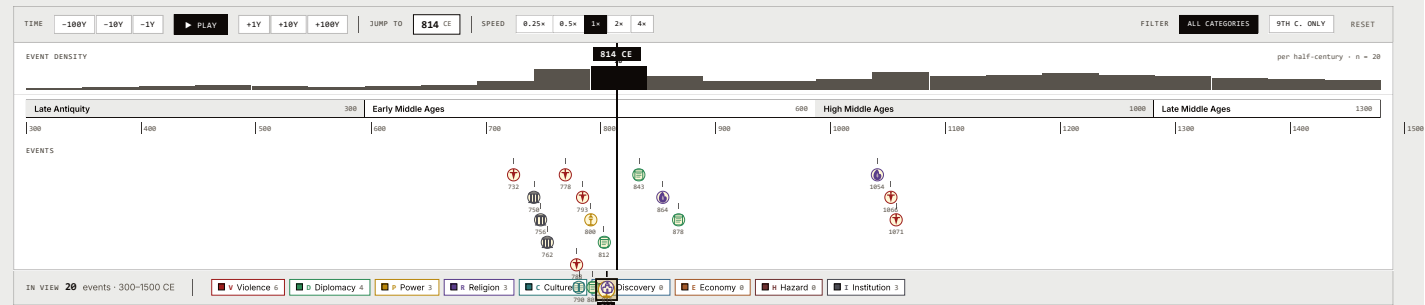
C. Bottom strip, command bar, not pill buttons

Old: row of pill 'Register', 'Factors', 'Search prose' buttons sitting on the parchment, plus a separate count strip. New: a single status bar locked to the bottom; reads year, poities, current selection, and cursor coordinates; promotes keyboard shortcuts. Loses the pill-button vibe entirely.



Chronoscope

One year cursor, four reading layers: era ribbons (the period), century markers (the structure), event density (the rhythm), and the event stud rail (the substance).
Selecting any event flies the map to its coords and opens the card.



STORYLINE · TWO-ENTITY CHRONICLE

CA

Carolingian Empire

751-843

x

BY

Byzantine Empire

330-1453

SWAP

A ↔ B

ADD 3RD ENTITY

EXPORT

x

RANGE

751

1453

754 → 843 CE (89 years · 12 entries)

YEAR

CAROLINGIAN EMPIRE →

→ BYZANTINE EMPIRE

754

Donation of Pepin

Frankish king grants central Italy to Pope.

RELATION · ALLIANCE

768

POWER · CHARLEMAGNE

Charlemagne accedes

Joint kingship with brother Carloman, sole king from 771.

774

VIOLENCE · LOMBARD

Lombard kingdom conquered

Pavia falls. Charlemagne assumes Iron Crown.

781

Betrothal pact

Rotrud betrothed to Constantine VI, later annulled.

RELATION · MARRIAGE

787

Second Council of Nicaea

Empress Irene restores icon veneration.

RELIGION · SECOND

797

Irene blinds Constantine VI

Sole rule by an empress, controversial in West.

POWER · IRENE

800

POWER · IMPERIAL

Imperial coronation

Leo III crowns Charlemagne Emperor, "two emperors problem" born.

802

Diplomatic standoff

Aachen claims imperial dignity; Constantinople disputes.

RELATION · RIVALRY

812

Pax Nicephori

Byzantium recognizes Frankish imperial title in exchange for Venetia.

RELATION · TREATY

814

POWER · DEATH

Death of Charlemagne

Louis the Pious sole heir.

820

Michael II accedes

Amorian dynasty begins

POWER · MICHAEL

YEAR 814 | MODE focus | FOCUS Carolingian Empire | CURSOR 540, 410 + 5.2°E 49.8°N · Aachen

YEAR 814 | MODE compare | FOCUS Carolingian Empire | CURSOR 540, 410 + 5.2°E 49.8°N · Aachen | focus compare research toggle col close card keys

HISTORICAL ATLAS - ENV-AT

Workspace · research

LAYOUT [1] [2] [3]

[search · run command · jump year] /

III

★

☰

👤

🏠

V

D

P

B

C

+ ALL

A · SUBJECT [planned]

++ + - x

|| POLITY · CAROLINGIAN -- - + - x

CA

Carolingian Empire

751-843 · 82y
WESTERN EUROPE

CAPITAL Aachen

RELIGION Latin Christianity

POP. ~ 1.814

RULER Pepin the Short · 751-768

|| LINEAGE 5 -- - + - x

Charles Martel	714-741 27y
Pepin the Short	751-768 17y
Charlemagne · PRESENT EMPEROR	768-814 45y
Louis the Pious · PRESENT EMPEROR	814-880 26y
Lothair I EMPEROR	840-855 15y

B · SUBJECT [planned]

++ + - x

|| POLITY · BYZANTINE -- - + - x

BY

Byzantine Empire

330-1453 · 1123y
BYZANTINE WORLD

CAPITAL Constantinople

RELIGION Eastern (Chalcedonian) Christianity

POP. ~ 1.814

RULER Nikephoros I · 802-811

|| NETWORK 9 -- - + - x

alliance 1

rivalry 1

tributary 1

C · WORKBENCH

++ + - x

|| EVENT · P -- - + - x

Death of Charlemagne

814 CE · POWER · SUCCESSION_CRISIS

Charlemagne dies at Aachen, 28 January 814. Louis the Pious inherits the empire intact. but the question of partible inheritance among the next generation is unresolved.

OUTCOMES

LOUIS_THE_PIOUS_SUCCEEDS

PARTIBLE_INHERITANCE_QUESTION

|| FACTOR BALANCE 14 / 9 -- - + - x

	RISE	DECLINE
MILITARY	3	1
ECONOMIC	3	1
RELIGIOUS	4	0
CULTURAL	2	8
DYNASTIC	8	4

|| SOURCES 4 -- - + - x

Costambeys, M. 2011

The Carolingian World

24 +

McKitterick, R. 2008

Charlemagne: The Formation..

19 +

Nelson, J. L. 2019

King and Emperor: A New Life

16 +

Wickham, C. 2009

The Inheritance of Rome

11 +

YEAR 814

MODE research

FOCUS Carolingian Empire

CURSOR 540, 410 → 5.2°E 49.8°N · Aachen

[1] focus

[2] compare

[3] research

[4] toggle col

[5] close card

[7] query

Component sheet

Every UI primitive is one place. All styles reference the tokens in `tokens.css` plus the additions in `styles.css`. Components compose into the panels and views in the other artboards.

v.8 - draw-atlas

01 Typography

Carolingian Empire

Coronation of Charlemagne

Aachen palace school

Charles Martel halted the Umayyad advance at Tours.

A note in the margin of the chronicle.

LIFE CYCLE PAPER

18,000,000

800-824 C6

CONSTANTINOPOLIS

Mare Nostrum

02 Color

Parchment + gilt, three ink scales. No bright Uli blues.

Figure 1: Schematic representation of the 1000 Genomes Project. The figure shows a hierarchical structure of the genome. At the top, the genome is divided into five large blocks: CHROM1, CHROM2, CHROM3, CHROM4, and CHROM5. Below these, the genome is further divided into smaller blocks, each representing a chromosome. The blocks are color-coded: CHROM1 (red), CHROM2 (green), CHROM3 (yellow), CHROM4 (purple), and CHROM5 (blue). The blocks are labeled with their respective chromosome numbers and the number of individuals in the population. The blocks are arranged in a grid-like structure, with the chromosomes on the left and the individuals on the right. The individuals are represented by small colored squares, each corresponding to a chromosome. The colors of the squares match the colors of the chromosome blocks. The individuals are arranged in a grid, with the chromosomes on the left and the individuals on the right. The individuals are labeled with their respective chromosome numbers and the number of individuals in the population. The individuals are arranged in a grid, with the chromosomes on the left and the individuals on the right. The individuals are labeled with their respective chromosome numbers and the number of individuals in the population.

83 Crests · entity identity

Two-letter microgram in a hatched square, with a region color band along the bottom. Solves the 'which polity is this' problem at every scale.

Figure 1 illustrates the process of generating a color code for a word. The top row shows color-coded boxes for the letters C, A, B, Y, A, B, A, C, A, S, A, S, A, G, B, G, K, H, P, S, each with a corresponding word below it: carnation, by, abbas, ac, as, as, as, angel, flower, flower, flower, paper. The bottom row shows a sequence of boxes: CA, CA, CA, CA, followed by the text 'see 22 - red 52 - 2g 48 - 45 46'.

84 Chips · slab, not pill

Micro caps. Hairline border. No rounded corners, pills read All-generic.

EMPEROR CHRISTOPHER SUCCESSOR-DOPE CALIPHATE GOLDEN-AGE ISLAMIC HEBTARCHY
 professor revised Claude drafted cited - 24
 alliance rivalry vassalage tributary trade marriage religions successor

85 Buttons

Flat, monospaced uppercase. Pressed = dark slab. No hover glow. Buttons that act on data are full slabs; secondary actions use ghosts.

DEFAULT ACTU8 / P853MD GH0ST = same family - slices by padding

86 Rows · left-keyed

The load-bearing list pattern, preserved from §12. Color comes from data, relationship type, event category, factor layer.

Papal Status Anasazi	since 750
Location of People	
Byzantine Empire Constantine	since 800
Two empires problem	
Abbasid Caliphate Abbasids in Baghdad, 750	since 750
Umayyad Córdoba Abbasids	since 750
Spanish March	

07 Event glyphs · 24 px ink-line

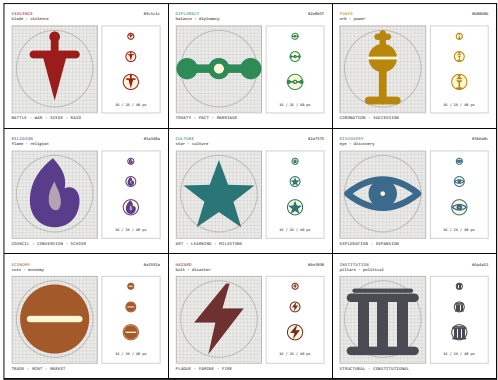
07/09/2017, 10h

Glyph studio

• **Legend:** 20x14 pts, 1.6 pt default stroke. Thinner than the first pass so they read on the map at 12 pt and in the legend at 32 pt. Categories are color coded.
• subtype overrides glo that reading treaty = marriage, siege = pitched battle, Heraldry and terrain glyphs at exception.

A Event categories - the nine

Color = category. Each event also has a subtype glyph if available (see block B); these defaults for when no subtype matches.



B Subtype glyphs - finer reading on the map

When an event's 'type' matches one of these, the map also uses this glyph instead of the category default, so a treaty doesn't look the same as a marriage, and a siege doesn't look the same as a pitched battle.

 Siege #000000 - #000000000000	 Battle / naval #000000 - #000000000000	 Treaty / charter #000000 - #000000000000	 Proclamation #000000 - #000000000000
 Fortified #000000 - #000000000000	 Council #000000 - #000000000000	 Mosque / Islam #000000 - #000000000000	 Islamic faith #000000 - #000000000000
 Orthodox faith #000000 - #000000000000	 Cleric / learning #000000 - #000000000000	 Trade caravan #000000 - #000000000000	 Fire #000000 - #000000000000
 Famine #000000 - #000000000000	 Plague #000000 - #000000000000		

C Heraldry - entity markers

Used to mark imperial / royal entities on the map and in EntityPanel/headers, distinct from event studs.

 Imperial eagle #000000	 Fleur-de-lis #000000	 Cavalry / migration #000000	 Military command #000000
---	---	--	---

D Map furniture - towers, bridges, terrain

Shown on the map alongside the entity polygons. Capital towers always show; the others appear with their respective layer toggle.

 Capital tower #000000	 Castle #000000	 Bridge #000000	 Mountain #000000
 Forest #000000	 Boat #000000	 Direction #000000	 Settlement #000000

E Stud parade - how they read on the map

A line-up of every glyph at the size it ships on the map (32 pts). This is the real test: read at a glance, no labels.



F North compass

Shown in the bottom-left corner of the map.

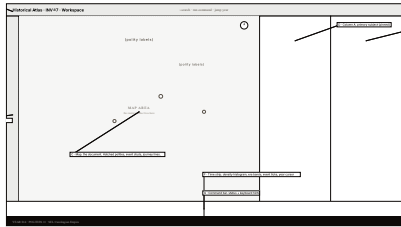


The Atlas. how it works

A 5-minute walkthrough of every surface, control, and gesture. The Atlas reads like a research instrument you set a year, the map filters to what existed then, and panels open in the right-hand dock for whatever you select. Nothing floats and nothing overlaps, every surface has a fixed slot.

01 The anatomy

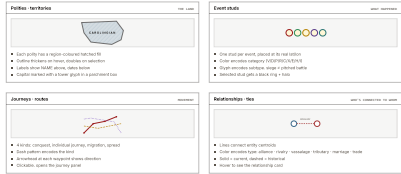
Six fixed regions. Nothing else floats.



The tag is the document. The chrome around it is the instrument that interrogates it. The dock on the right slides between layouts: Focus (1 column), Compare (2 columns), Research (3 columns).

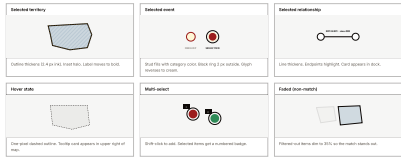
82 The map

Feed like a pirated alien. Never anything to see its identity card!



03 Selection

Click anything. The direction is impossible to miss.



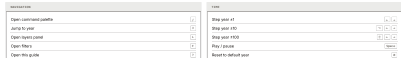
64 Controls · the chrome

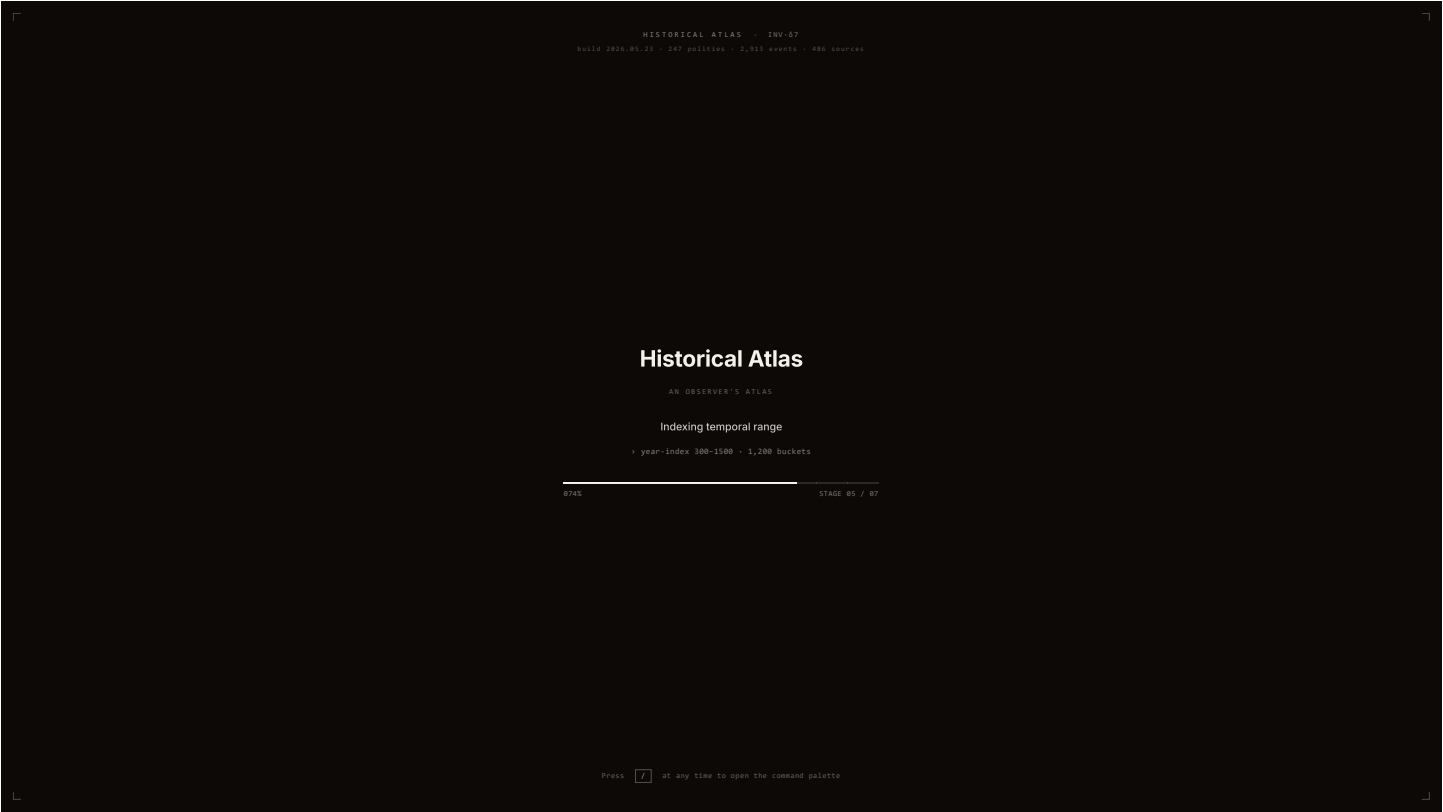
Every input affects the instrument.



05 Keyboard

Every gesture has a direction.





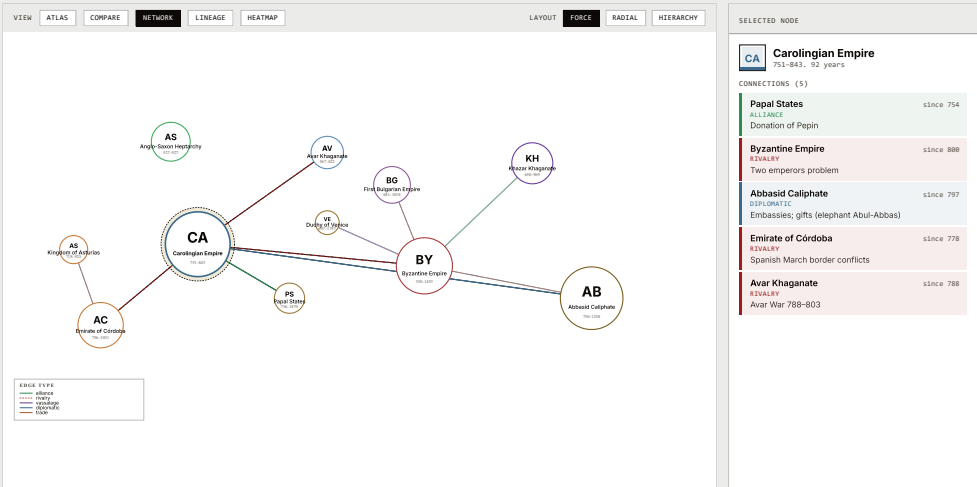
ARTBOARD · 15

Other views

Two analytical views that are not the map. The same data, read differently. The view switcher in the top bar moves between Atlas, Compare, Network, Lineage, and Heatmap. Each view inherits the current year, the current selection, and the current filters.

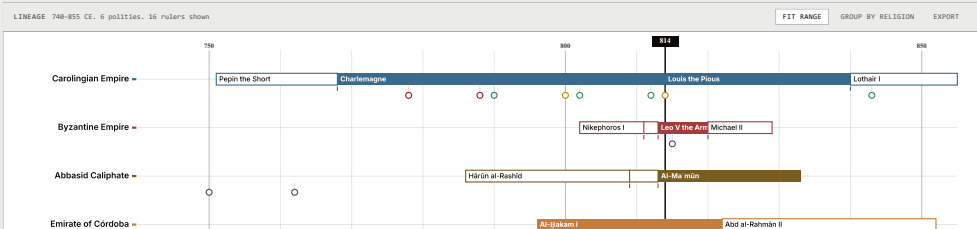
A. Network

Polities as nodes, relationships as edges. Force-laid; nodes can be dragged.



B. Lineage

Every ruler of every polity on a single year axis. Reigns as bars, succession events as connectors.



Command palette

One key opens it. Type to fuzzy-match across entities, events, sources, and direct commands. Arrow keys to navigate. Enter to commit. Results are grouped by kind so you always see what you're acting on.

QUERY STATE. JUST OPENED
NEW QUERY: TYPING 'CAR'
3 sections, 9 hits

> search entities, events, sources | Esc

RECENT

- B **Carolingian Empire**
POLITY, 751-843 opened 2h ago
- T **Treaty of Verdun**
EVENT, 843 CE, Diplomacy opened 1d ago
- B **Byzantine Empire**
POLITY, 330-1453 opened 1d ago

SUGGESTIONS

- > **Set year, 814**
jump cursor to Death of Charlemagne
- > **Compare Carolingian × Byzantine**
opens compare mode
- > **Open layers**
show layer panel L

To navigate ⌘ open 🔍 open in compare powered by - local index

> **ch** Esc

B **Charlemagne, as ruler of Carolingian Empire**
800 CE, emperor

B **Charles the Bald**
843-877, emperor of West Francia

EVENTS

- T **Charlemagne's Italian Campaign**
773-774, conquest
- I **Coronation of Charlemagne**
800 CE, power
- I **Death of Charlemagne**
814 CE, succession
- E **Embassy of Charlemagne to Harun al-Rashid**
802 CE, diplomacy
- I **Charlemagne assumes Iron Crown**
774 CE, coronation

SOURCES

- S **Costambeys. The Carolingian World**
2011, 14 citations
- S **Nelson, King and Emperor: A New Life of Charlemagne**
2019, 19 citations

To navigate ⌘ open 🔍 open in compare powered by - local index

SLASH-COMMAND MODE type / for actions numeric input

/ / Esc

TIME

- > **/year, nnn** 3
jump cursor to year nnn
- > **/play** Space
start playback
- > **/range, yyyy-yyyy**
constrain timeline to range

VIEW

- > **/focus** [F]
single-column workspace
- > **/compare a b** [C]
open A & B side by side
- > **/research** [R]
three-column workbench
- > **/network**
switch to network view
- > **/lineage**
switch to lineage view

LAYERS

- > **/show name**
enable a layer by name
- > **/hide name**
disable a layer
- > **/solo name**
hide everything except one layer

To navigate ⌘ open 🔍 open in compare powered by - local index

ARTBOARD · 17

System states

Every part of the system needs a deliberate empty, error, and intermediate state. These are the patterns. Each follows the same three-part rule: a calm headline, a clear cause, and the single most useful action.

● NO SELECTIONEMPTY



Nothing selected

Click a polity, event, or relationship on the map to open it here.

OPEN RANDOM POLITY

● EMPTY FILTEREMPTY



No events match

Your filter excluded every event in the current year. Try broadening category or expanding the date range.

RESET FILTERS

● NO DATA FOR YEAREMPTY



No records for 1432

This dataset starts in the year 300 and is sparse in the 15th century. Move the cursor to a denser period.

JUMP TO 814 CE

● FAILED TO LOADERROR



Could not load polity data

The data manifest at v.2026.05.23 returned an error. The local cache is intact and is being shown.

RETRY

GET /data/entities/_index.json → 503

● OFFLINEERROR



You are offline

The full dataset is cached locally. New entity reviews and shared views will sync when the connection returns.

● SOURCE UNVERIFIEDERROR



This entry is community-drafted

It has not yet been reviewed by a domain expert. Cited claims load on click; treat with caution.

SEE DRAFT

● LOADING INLINELOADING



Loading 247 polities

Indexing temporal range and resolving spatial keys. This usually takes under a second.

● TILE STREAMINGLOADING



Reading 4,080 settlements

The settlements layer streams from the spatial KDTree as the viewport changes.

4,888 of 4,088 ✓

● COMPARE SLOT EMPTYPEMPTY



Drop a second entity here

Drag any polity from the map or use the command palette to pick one.

PICK FROM LIST

ARTBOARD • 15

Inspectors & tooltips

Three tiers of identification, by how much screen they occupy. Hover, tip (smallest, just enough to identify). Inspector (compact, full identity, primary actions). Card in dock (full panel).

A. Hover tip

Appears in the upper-right of the map. Always small, never blocks the thing it describes

RELIGION	EVENT	JOURNEY
POLITY: WESTERN EUROPE Carolingian Empire 751-843, 80 years ■ Aachen capital. Pop. 18M	1 Coronation of Charlemagne 7, 800 CE, COORDINATION Pope Leo III crowns Charlemagne Emperor of the Romans on Christmas Day.	EMPEROR: WESTERASIA Frankish embassy to Harun al-Rashid 801-802 CE, 5 weeks, 4,200 km Aachen → Rome → Constantinople → Damascus → Baghdad
RELATIONSHIP: POWER	CAPITAL: POWER	SETTLEMENT (LOW-COMP)
RELATIONSHIP: RIVALRY 854 - 859 Carolingian + Byzantine since 800, Two emperors' problem	CAPITAL Constantinople Byzantine Empire 41.87°N, 28.37°E Pop. c. 500,000 (30% C.). Walls of Theodosius Road.	SETTLEMENT Reric (Mecklenburg) 54-57°N, 12-17°E Ostfries trading site. Sacked by Godfred 808. Inland resettlement at Hedeby.

B. Inspector

Compact open-on-click panel, 280-320 px wide. Lives in the upper-right of the map until docked

C. Citations & sources

Provenance lives at the citation level. Every claim cites a source; sources cite themselves recursively.

SOURCE

id: carolingians-2061

The Carolingian World
 Costantini, Innes, Maclean, 2011
 Cambridge University Press, vol. 4, 487 pp.

USED BY

- Carolingian Empire entry 14+
- Coronation of Charlemagne 4+
- Treaty of Verdun 1+
- Carolingian Renaissance 2+
- Frankish embassy to Baghdad 1+

STATUS

peer-reviewed PRIMARY SURVEY

At Charlemagne's death the empire stretched from the Ebro to the Elbe^[1] and from the North Sea to central Italy^{[1], [2]}. It was the largest unified polity in western Christendom since Rome^[1]. Population estimates place it at 18 million, ± 30% [2].

REFERENCED (3)

- 1 Costantini, Innes, Maclean. The Carolingian World (2011) p. 34
- 2 McKitterick, Charlemagne: The Formation... (2008) p. 102
- 3 Wickham. The Inheritance of Rome (2009) p. 374

ARTBOARD · 19

Filters & Saved Views

Filters narrow what's drawn. Saved views remember the whole state (year, layers, filters, selection, layout). Both surface from the same place in the right dock so the user always knows where to find them.

FILTER PANEL

press F

FILTERS

CLEAR

SAVE AS VIEW

TIME RANGE

700 to 900 CE

700 to 900 CE

EVENT CATEGORY

5 of 9

V Violence

P Power

C Culture

E Economy

I Institution

D Diplomacy

R Religion

X Discovery

H Hazards

REGION

3 of 16

WESTERN EUROPE

BYZANTINE WORLD

ISLAMIC WORLD

BRITISH ISLES

IBERIA

CENTRAL ASIA

SOUTHEASTERN EUROPE

POLITY TYPE

any

EMPIRE

KINGDOM

CALIPHATE

DUCHY

EMIRATE

THEOCRACY

KHAGANATE

REPUBLIC

CONFIDENCE

reviewed + community

Reviewed

Community

Disputed

peer-reviewed

drafted, unverified

experts disagree

TAGS

any of 5

SEARCH TAGS

SUCCESSOR-ROMO

CHRISTENDOM

FRONTIER

ICONOCLASM

TRADE-NETWORK

showing 11 of 247 polities, 16 of 2,913 events

APPLY

CANCEL

SAVED VIEWS

+ NEW

SORT

filter by name or tag...

Charlemagne's empire at 814

2 days ago

THESIS TESTS SHOT

814 CE

COMPARE

ALL

planned

Viking age, 793-1066

5 days ago

scrub to compare raids

850 CE

ATLAS

EVENTS + JOURNEYS

Iconoclasm in Byzantium

1 week ago

for chapter 4

815 CE

FOCUS

RELIGION + CAPITALS

Carolingian x Byzantine rivalry

2 weeks ago

Pax Nicephori context

882 CE

COMPARE

RELATIONSHIPS ONLY

Mediterranean trade, 9c

1 month ago

draft, sources thin

850 CE

ATLAS

TRADE ROUTES + CITIES

draft

Eastern Roman frontier

1 month ago

Arabs raids

700 CE

RESEARCH

MILITARY + EVENTS

6 views, 1 pinned

IMPORT...

ACTIVE FILTER BAR

hits below header when filters applied

FILTERED

700 to 900 CE

V violence

P power

R religion

western europe

+ 3 MORE

11 of 247 polities, 16 of 2,913 events

CLEAR ALL

SAVE VIEW

ARTBOARD · 28

Sources Library

The bibliography behind everything the Atlas shows. Each source records how often it's cited, what it covers, and whether a domain expert has signed off. Click any source for the full citation tree, or browse by what kind of evidence it provides.

SOURCES	PEER REVIEWED	PRIMARY	TOTAL CITATIONS
14 show all	13/14 95%	2 contemporary witness	401 across all entities

search by author, title, id...

KIND

ALL

PRIMARY

MONOGRAPH

BIOGRAPHY

SURVEY

EDITED

POPULAR

SORT

citations ↓

EXPORT ROSTER

SOURCE	YEAR	KIND	STATUS	COVERS	CITED
The Carolingian World Costambeys, Innes, MacLean. Cambridge UP. id. costambeys-2011	2011	Monograph	✓ reviewed	4 polities. 12 events	47 ✓
Charlemagne. The Formation of a European Identity McKitterick, R.. Cambridge UP. id. mckitterick-2008	2008	Monograph	✓ reviewed	1 polities. 9 events	38 ✓
King and Emperor. A New Life of Charlemagne Nelson, J. L., Allen Lane. id. nelson-2019	2019	Biography	✓ reviewed	1 polities. 14 events	32 ✓
The Inheritance of Rome. A History of Europe 400-1000 Wickham, C.. Penguin. id. wickham-2009	2009	Survey	✓ reviewed	9 polities. 17 events	28 ✓
A History of the Byzantine State and Society Treadgold, M.. Stanford UP. id. treadgold-2007	1997	Survey	✓ reviewed	1 polities. 22 events	41 ✓
The Prophet and the Age of the Caliphates Kennedy, H.. Pearson Longman. id. kennedy-2004	2004	Survey	✓ reviewed	2 polities. 9 events	24 ✓
The Cross and the Crescent Fletcher, S., Viking. id. fletcher-2003	2003	Popular	draft	5 polities. 7 events	14 ✓
Charlemagne Collins, R., Routledge. id. collins-1998	1998	Biography	✓ reviewed	1 polities. 10 events	22 ✓
Images, Iconoclasm, and the Carolingians Nasr, S. F. R., U Penn Press. id. nasr-2009	2009	Monograph	✓ reviewed	2 polities. 5 events	11 ✓
Cultures in Contact in Frankish Europe Farrasius, P., Routledge. id. farrasius-2013	2013	Edited	✓ reviewed	4 polities. 6 events	9 ✓
Warfare and Society in the Barbarian West Halsall, R., Routledge. id. halsall-2009	2003	Monograph	✓ reviewed	8 polities. 14 events	19 ✓
Europe after Rome Salway, P. R., Oxf. UP. id. salway-2012	2012	Survey	✓ reviewed	11 polities. 11 events	16 ✓
Annales regni Francorum Assmann (compiler). primary source. id. 807-88	829	Primary	✓ reviewed	1 polities. 28 events	56 ✓
Chronographia Theophanes the Confessor. primary source. id. TheophConf	815	Primary	✓ reviewed	3 polities. 24 events	44 ✓

CO-CITATION GRAPH

edge weight = shared citers, node = source, primary in gold

HEALTH

Poor reviewed

12 / 14

Primary witnesses

2 / 14

English secondary

11 / 14

Translated primary

2 / 14

Open access

4 / 14

Drafts (unverified)

1 / 14

MOST NEEDED

Arab and Persian secondary sources on the 8th-9th c.
Altabad state are thin. Two community drafts await peer review.

REQUEST REVIEW

ARTBOARD - 21

Editing & review

The Atlas is community-edited under expert review. Anyone can draft a change. Every change must cite a source before submission. Reviewers see the diff inline against the published version. Approved changes land into the next data manifest.

Editor view

Same panel as the reader sees, with inline edit affordances. Side toolbar reveals when you toggle Edit on.

DRAFT **Carolingian Empire** R.241 + R.242 (draft) DISCARD PREVIEW SUBMIT FOR REVIEW

DESCRIPTION - EDITED
NOTICE: PARAGRAPHS

The Carolingian Empire was the Frankish state under Charlemagne and his heirs. At his death in 814 the realm stretched ~~from the Pyrenees to the Elbe~~ and from the North Sea to central Italy ^{CIT1} ~~It was sometimes called the First Reich.~~ ~~It was the largest unified polity in western Christendom since the dissolution of the western Roman state.~~ ^{CIT2}

FIELDS

CAPITAL	Aachen	UNCHANGED	No source
RELIGION	Latin Christianity	UNCHANGED	No source
POPULATION ESTIMATE	20,000,000 15,000,000	CHANGED	✓ Carolingian 2008
ETHNICITY	Frankish Frankish, Lombard, Saxon, Bavarian	CHANGED	✓ McKittrick-Luk 2008
LANGUAGES	None Old High German, Lombardic, Latin	ADDED	✓ Wickham 2009

EDIT SUMMARY (REQUIRED)

Tightened the description, restored cited population estimate, added ethnic and linguistic breakdown per McKittrick 2008 and Wickham 2009. Removed unsourced 'First Reich' claim.

EDIT

CITE

HISTORY

TALK

SOURCES

PREVIEW

Source picker

Every claim must point to a source. The picker searches the sources library; new sources are added in the same flow.

CITE A SOURCE For: "population estimate: 15,000,000"

> costanbays.carolingian.world [See](#)

The Carolingian World
Costanbays, Zorab, McLean., 2011

[✓ reviewed](#)

Charlemagne. The Formation of a European Identity
McKittrick, R., 2008

[✓ reviewed](#)

The Carolingian Renaissance
Yarnoff, M., 2019

[✓ reviewed](#)

Can't find it? add a new source -- CANCEL CITE THIS

Diff view

What a reviewer sees. Old on the left, draft on the right. Color-coded by claim status.

DIFF **Carolingian Empire** R.241 (published) vs R.242 (draft) REQUEST CHANGES APPROVE

R.241. PUBLISHED. 2024-09-12

The Carolingian Empire was the Frankish state under Charlemagne and his heirs. ~~It was sometimes called the First Reich.~~ The realm stretched from the Atlantic to central Europe.

POPULATION ESTIMATE
~~20,000,000~~
[No source](#)

3 paragraphs changed, 1 field changed, 0 sources added, 1 source removed

R.242. DRAFT. BY ELEK.N · 2 HOURS AGO

The Carolingian Empire was the Frankish state under Charlemagne and his heirs. The realm stretched ~~from the Pyrenees to the Elbe~~ and from the North Sea to central Italy. ~~It was the largest unified polity in western Christendom since the dissolution of the western Roman state.~~

POPULATION ESTIMATE
15,000,000
[✓ Carolingian 2008](#)

DIFF, unified · word · paragraph

Review queue

The reviewer's worklist. Sortable, filterable. Each item shows what's being changed, by whom, and why.

REVIEW QUEUE 5 pending · 1 dispute · 3 needs source [ALL](#) [READY](#) [DISPUTE](#) [NEEDS SOURCE](#) [NEW](#)

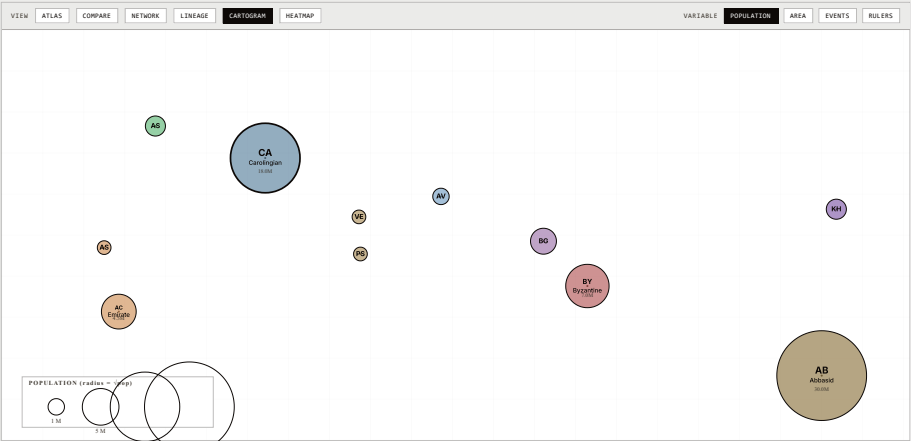
ARTBOARD • 22

Alternative map views

The base map shows territory. The cartogram resizes polities by population, putting political weight where the people are. The heatmap aggregates events into a smooth density surface, surfacing where history happened thickest.

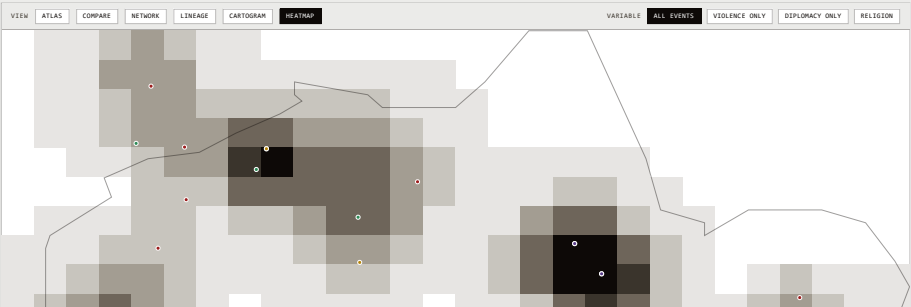
A. Cartogram, polities sized by population

A Döring-style cartogram. Each polity is a circle scaled to its population, repositioned by anchored force layout so big states sit near where they ruled.



B. Heatmap, event density across the world

A continuous density surface over the event corpus. Brightest where most happened.



ARTBOARD · 24

Compare table

Lock 2 or more entities side by side. Same fields, parallel cells. Rows highlight where they diverge. Add or remove entities from the column header.

FIELD	CA Carolingian Empire751-843	BY Byzantine Empire528-1453	AB Abbasid Caliphate750-1258	+ ADD
IDENTITY				
TYPE	empire	empire	caliphate	
REGION	western europe	byzantine world	islamic world european facing	
CAPITAL	Aachen	Constantinople	Baghdad	
FORMED → DISSOLVED	751-843	330-1453	750-1258	
DURATION	92 y	1123 y	508 y	
SOCIETY				
POPULATION (EST.)	18.8 M	7.8 M	30.0 M	
RELIGION	Latin Christianity	Eastern (Chalcedonian) Christianity	Sunni Islam	
PEOPLES	Frankish, Lombard	Greek, Armenian	Arab, Persian	
LANGUAGES	Old High German	Medieval Greek	Classical Arabic	
ACTIVITY (IN DATASET)				
EVENTS PLOTTED	9	3	2	
RULERS INDEXED	4	4	3	
PROVENANCE	professor reviewed	professor reviewed	professor reviewed	
IN YEAR 814 CE				
STATUS	active	active	active	
RULER	Charlemagne	Leo V the Armenian	Al-Ma'mūn	
PHASE	Peak → Succession	Iconoclast revival	Golden age (al-Ma'mūn)	
RELATIONSHIPS MATRIX how each row relates to each column				
CA Carolingian Empire	–	rivalry since 888 Two emperors problem	diplomatic since 797 Embassies; gifts (elephant Abul-Abbas)	
BY Byzantine Empire	rivalry since 800 Two emperors problem	–	rivalry since 700 Anatolian frontier raids	
AB Abbasid Caliphate	diplomatic since 797 Embassies; gifts (elephant Abul-Abbas)	rivalry since 750 Anatolian frontier raids	–	

Highlighted = largest in row

Cells differ across all entities

Bottom rule = section break

data version v.2026.05.23 · year: cursor: 814

ARTBOARD · 25

Notifications & help

Transient surfaces that explain what just happened, what's available, or what can be undone. Toasts stack bottom-right with auto-dismiss; the notification drawer carries the full history.

A. Toasts. transient bottom-right

(MAP AREA)

● View saved

"Charlemagne's empire at 814" added to your saved views.

SHOW →

just now

● Year cursor at 814 CE

3 events plotted at this year. The map shows 11 polities active.

SEE EVENTS →

just now

● Some events hidden

Your filter excludes 2,897 events. Reset to see all.

RESET FILTER →

just now

● Could not load /sources/_index.json

Showing the cached copy from 2026.05.20. New entries will not appear until reconnect.

RETRY →

just now

B. Notification drawer

NOTIFICATIONS

2 unread

PARK ALL READ

● elen.h replied to your thread

Population estimate: 18M vs 21M

2 m ago

● Your edit was approved

Carolingian Empire (r.242) is now live.

1 h ago

● Source flagged

Fletcher 2003 was marked "popular" by a reviewer.

3 h ago

● New shared view

scholar.m shared 'Carolingian × Byzantine rivalry'.

1 d ago

● Weekly summary

12 edits, 4 approved, 1 pending review.

1 w ago

RECENT ACTIONS. UNDO WITHIN 60S

HID Religion overlay layer

12s

UNDO

REMOVED Avar Khaganate from compare

38s

UNDO

FILTERED events to 700-900 CE

51s

UNDO

SET year to 814 CE

68s

UNDO

C. Contextual help. inline coach marks

ARTBOARD · 26

About the Atlas

The Atlas is a community-edited, expert-reviewed visualisation of medieval polities, events, and the ties between them. We make geography, time, and source legible at once.

POLITIES 247 Included across 1,628 polygon snapshots	EVENTS 2,913 across 32 categories	SOURCES 486 56 primary witnesses · 472 secondary	CONTRIBUTORS 124 33 domain experts
---	--	---	---

Mission

History is geographic, temporal, and source-rooted at the same time. Most tools show one of these well; few show all three. The Atlas aims to be the surface where you can read a polity in its full context, scrub through its life, follow what it traded and fought, and click straight to the source for every claim.

Every entry is cited. Every claim is reviewable. Drafts wait for an expert before they land. Disputes happen on the talk page, not in the data.

The data model

Six core record types compose the dataset. Each is versioned, has provenance, and carries a peer-review flag. The whole thing is shipped as a static JSON manifest you can fork.



A **polity** records a state's life: name, type, region, dates, capital, population, language, religion, polygon snapshots. An **event** is a point in space and time tied to a polity. A **journey** is a path with waypoints. A **relationship** is a typed tie between two polities. A **ruler** sits inside a polity's lineage. A **source**backs everything.

How we cite

Every cited claim points to a record in the sources library. A claim with no source is flagged "citation needed" on screen. Submissions without sources can't be merged. Primary witnesses (the Annales regni Francorum, Theophanes) are marked in gold; secondary scholarship is marked by peer-review status.

Versioning

v. 2026.05.23 2 days ago	Added 47 events in 11th c. Mediterranean. Reviewed Bulgarian Christianisation entry.	Signed Custabeyts
v. 2026.05.16 9 days ago	Anglo-Saxon Heptarchy split into 7 separate polities per scholar.r proposal.	Signed Howard
v. 2026.05.09 16 days ago	New cartogram view. Carolingian population revised: 21M → 18M with sources.	Signed Custabeyts
v. 2026.05.02 23 days ago	Added Khazar Judaism conversion event. Reviewed 4 community drafts.	Signed Howard
v. 2026.04.25 1 month ago	Sources library overhaul. BibTeX export. Co-citation graph.	Signed Custabeyts

STATUS

Build	v. 2026.05.23
Data manifest	2026.05.20
Coverage	980-1500 CE
Geographic	Europe + Med. + Near East
Maintained	active

MAINTAINERS

1	Prof. M. Custabeyts Editor-in-Chief, Cartogramian
2	Prof. J. Howard Reviewer, Scandinavia
3	Dr. H. Kennedy Reviewer, 10th-12thc. world
4	elen.h Contributor, Frankish events
5	scholar.r Reviewer, Anglo-Saxon

LICENCE & ACCESS

All textual content is licensed **CC BY-SA 4.0**. Code is **MIT**. The raw dataset is downloadable as a JSON manifest. Forks welcome.

1 DOWNLOAD MANIFEST (12.4 MB)
↗ SOURCE CODE ON GIT
↗ READ THE DATA SCHEMA

CONTRIBUTE

Spot an error? Have a source we don't? Open a thread on any entry's talk page, or submit an edit directly. New domain reviewers welcome with proof of academic affiliation.

[APPLY AS REVIEWER](#)

ARTBOARD · 27

Onboarding tour

The four panels shown on first visit. The map keeps rendering underneath; tour cards land in the position where the thing they describe lives, with a leader line.

STEP 1 / 4

The map is the document

Every shape is a polity. Every coloured dot is a recorded event. Hover anything to identify it, click to open it. The map redraws when you change the year.

?

open this tour again any time

SKIP THE TOUR

NEXT →

STEP 2 / 4

Time lives at the bottom

The chronoscope shows event density across history. Drag the cursor or type a year. Era bands and century rules tell you where you are at a glance.

Space

play / pause

SKIP THE TOUR

BACK

NEXT →

STEP 3 / 4

The dock holds your evidence

Whatever you select opens here as a card. Drag cards to reorder, pop them out, or switch the dock to **Compare** or **Research** for more columns.

96\

toggle the right column

SKIP THE TOUR

BACK

NEXT →

STEP 4 / 4

Cite, edit, and share

Every claim is sourced. Any community member can draft an edit, but expert reviewers sign off before changes land. Save the current view to share it.

/

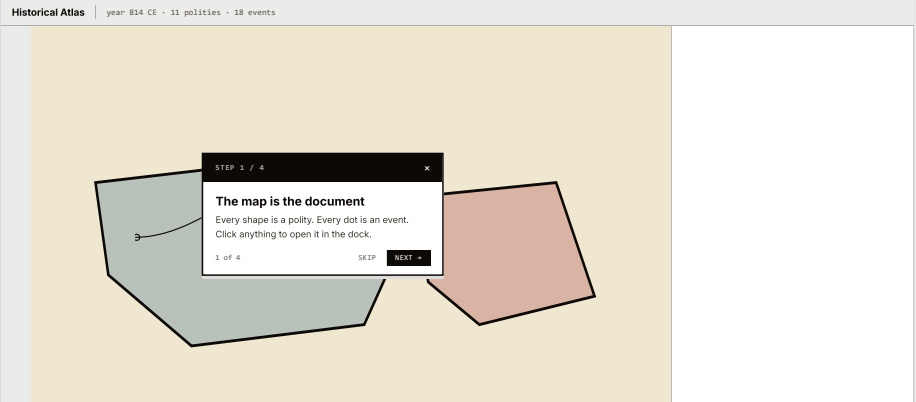
open the command palette

SKIP THE TOUR

BACK

DONE →

IN-PLACE CARD. HOW IT SITS OVER THE MAP



[Print sheet](#)

What ships when the user prints or exports a PDF. The map gets a print-only treatment: full-bleed across the page, with the entity card pinned to a sidebar and footnotes gathered at the bottom. A4 portrait, 12 mm margins.

Historical Atlas

Carolingian Empire, 814 CE

page 1 of 1

2020-05-20 - printed 2020-05-20

The map shows the Carolingian Empire in 814 CE, a vast territory stretching from the Pyrenees in the south to the North Sea in the north, and from the Atlantic coast in the west to central Italy in the east. The empire is divided into several regions, each marked with a number and a letter. The regions are: CORDOBA (1, A), CAROLINGIA (2, B), BYZANTINE (3, C), and ABBASID (4, D). The map also shows the Mediterranean Sea (MARE NOSTRUM) to the east and south. A scale bar indicates a distance of 500 km. A north arrow is located in the top right corner.

AT A GLANCE
Type empire
Capital Aachen
Ruler Charlemagne (768-814)
Religion Latin Christianity
Population 18 M (±10%)
Spoken 753-801: 104 v.
EVENTS ON THIS PAGE
1. 752 Battle of Tours
2. 778 Battle of Roncesvalles
3. 814 Death of Charlemagne
4. 833 Second Iconoclasm
5. 762 Foundation of Baghdad

RELATIONSHIPS
Alliance with Papal States since 754.
Rivalry with Byzantine Empire since 800.
Diplomatic with Abbasid Caliphate since 797.
Rivalry with Cordoba since 778.

OVERVIEW

The Carolingian Empire was the largest unified polity in western Christendom since the dissolution of the western Roman state.¹ Forged through the campaigns of Charles Martel, Pepin the Short, and Charlemagne, it stretched at Charlemagne's death from the Pyrenees to the Elbe and from the North Sea to central Italy.² Population estimates place it at approximately 18 million.³ Its administrative innovations, the Carolingian Renaissance, and the imperial coronation of 800 made it the constitutive event of medieval European political identity.⁴

SOURCES

1. Coomans, R., Innes, M., & MacLean, S. (2018). *The Carolingian World*. Cambridge University Press, pp. 34, 102.
2. Mathews, G. (2008). *Charlemagne: The Formation of a European Identity*. Cambridge University Press, p. 102.
3. Wisham, C. (2008). *The Inheritance of Rome*. Penguin, p. 374.
4. Nelson, J. L. (2018). *King and Emperor: A New Life of Charlemagne*. Allen Lane, ch. 12.

etlas.example.nl/en/814-conv2

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DATA DICTIONARY

DATA DICTIONARY

Every record type, every field. What it means, what it's typed as, whether it's required, what enums are allowed. This is the schema. If a contributor's data doesn't fit, this is the file to update.

CONCEPTS

polity

14 fields

event

9 fields

journey

5 fields

relationship

6 fields

note

6 fields

source

18 fields

polity

/data/polity/country.json

14 fields · 9 required

A historical political entity. Empire, kingdom, caliphate, duchy, etc. Carries dates of existence, polygons over time, capital, demographics and cultural facts.

FIELD	TYPE	REQ.	NOTES	EXAMPLE
id	string	required	Lowercase snake_case slug. Permanent.	conestoga_empire
name_primary	string	required	The canonical English form.	Conestoga Empire
name_variants	string[]	optional	Latinized, native, alt spellings.	["Tupper Law Noamaw"]
type	enum enum = "kingdom" caliphate = "caliphate"	required	—	empire
region	enum enum = "america" polity = "polity"	required	—	western_america
founded	int (year)	required	Founding year. Negative for BCE.	750
dissolved	int (year)	required	Last year of existence as polity.	800
capital_history	object[]	required	Capitals over time. Most maps show the active one.	[[name, from, to, lat, lon]]
polity_mapshots	object[]	required	Territorial extent at key years. Interpolated between.	[[year, polygon: [[lat, lon]]]]
religion	string	optional	—	Latin Christianity
ethnicity	string	optional	—	
languages	string[]	optional	—	
population_estimates	object[]	optional	—	[[year, low, mid, high, source]]
tags	string[]	optional	—	["empire", "texasian-rom"]
provenance	Provenance	required	(relationship, data_received, data, status_code)	

event

/data/event/country.json

9 fields · 6 required

A point in space and time tied to a polity. Battles, treaties, conversions, council, etc. Coordinates are real lat/lon.

FIELD	TYPE	REQ.	NOTES	EXAMPLE
id	string	required	—	battle_of_bour_fri
name	string	required	—	battle of bour
year	int	required	—	750
type	enum enum = "battle" battle = "battle"	required	—	battle
category	enum enum = "battle" battle = "battle"	required	Determines what color is legend.	violence
coords	[lat, lon]	required	—	[40.4, -9.4]
entity	polity_id	required	—	conestoga_empire
summary	string	required	1-2 sentence prose.	
outcome	string[]	optional	Tagged downstream effects.	["war", "expansion", "death"]

journey

/data/journey/country.json

5 fields · 4 required

A path with waypoints. Conquests, migrations, negotiations, spread of ideas.

FIELD	TYPE	REQ.	NOTES	EXAMPLE
id	string	required	—	
name	string	required	—	
kind	enum enum = "conquest" conquest = "conquest"	required	—	
year_start	int	required	—	
year_end	int	required	—	
waypoints	[lat, lon, label[]]	required	—	[[40.4, -9.4, "Vastus"]]

relationship

/data/relationship/country.json

6 fields · 4 required

Typical fit between two polities. Used for the network graph and the line layer on the map.

FIELD	TYPE	REQ.	NOTES	EXAMPLE
id	string	required	—	
name	string	required	—	
kind	enum enum = "conquest" conquest = "conquest"	required	—	
year_start	int	required	—	
year_end	int	required	—	
waypoints	[lat, lon, label[]]	required	—	[[40.4, -9.4, "Vastus"]]

Historical Atlas. design spec

Keep this open next to your editor. Every categorical thing in the system, in one place.

v.2026.05.23
printed 2026.05.23

[illegible]

Print this page. It is the contract.

atlas.example/spec - CC BY-SA 4.0

